

Think of a special occasion coming up this year, like an anniversary or birthday. Now imagine I gave you a challenge: *How could you make it magical?* Not just a “nice” dinner, for instance—an incredible one. Not just the usual birthday celebration—an extraordinary night that you’ll never forget.

What would you do differently?

In this section, we’re going to talk about dreaming *bigger* to use money to create memorable, meaningful, magical memories.

This is important. I want you to know exactly how you’ll spend your money as it grows, all the way down to the exact hotel where you want to stay, or the unexpectedly generous amount you want to donate to your local charity. I want you to visualize what it will feel like to hand over a 30 percent tip—or even 100 percent!—to your server. Getting into this level of detail is a key part of what makes a Rich Life worth living. You’ll start to see the pieces of your Rich Life coming together.

After our wedding, my wife and I took a long honeymoon. On the last day, she told me something I’ll never forget. “Usually, I would be sad at the end of a trip like this,” she said. “But I know we can always come back.”

Now *that’s* abundance. When we travel, we don’t have to see and do everything on our itinerary, because we know that we can stay for an extra day or two if we want—or just come back next year.

This section is also personal for me because of something I experienced in my childhood. Growing up, there were certain places where I felt I belonged, like our temple and the local pizza place in our neighborhood. But there were other places—like expensive clothing stores, luxury hotels, and the front of the airplane—that I knew weren’t for me or my family.

As I got older, I started to wonder what kind of people went in those stores. Why did a certain restaurant charge ten times more than our pizza place? What could ever be worth *that much money*?

Looking back, I’ve always wanted to know what drives the very best in the world, like top athletes, Nobel Prize-winning scientists, and special forces in the military. But my curiosity was also competitive: If someone else could afford to go in there, I wanted to know how *I* could do it too.

In money, that sense of curiosity can open your eyes to many new possibilities. Yes, there are people who spend a huge amount on clothes or cars or travel. Good! Let’s try to understand why they do it. It doesn’t mean we have to agree, but let’s first assume they’re making good decisions. What do they know that we don’t?